communism's "rigidity," "suppression of human freedom," and close association "with the necessity for violence."[186]

Concern about Sino-Soviet behavior also led to (and was caused by) greater Indian apprehension about their potential interference in domestic politics.[187] Nehru worried that India's communists' "thinking apparatus live[d] outside India," where their loyalties lay.[188] It did not help when the Soviet ambassador to China wrote a vociferous critique of Nehru's article and Indian economic policies. To rub it in, the Soviet diplomat even included statistics to show that China was making greater progress than India.[189] This left Nehru agreeing with Dutt that the communists were only becoming more rigid.[190]

Mediating No More

Indian policymakers could not help but compare how differently the US and the Sino-Soviet bloc dealt with disagreements during this period. Differences between the US and India on China, for example, had not disappeared. But as the American chargé in Delhi noted in December 1956, the two countries had reached the stage where they could "agree to disagree."[191] This acceptance of differences with the US on China, along with Delhi's disappointments with Beijing, aided the Indian relationship with the US in two ways. First, it made Delhi less inclined to mediate between Beijing and Washington—consequently reducing the instances where it could be accused of siding with Beijing. Second, it made India more understanding of American policy toward China. This removed a key thorn in the relationship, at least as far as the executive branch in each country was concerned.

Despite contemplating—on his officials' advice—another attempt in spring 1956 to get China and the US to resolve the question of American prisoners in China, Nehru decided against involvement. He did not think India could do anything more to convince the Chinese leadership to act.[192] Furthermore, Nehru did not want to make any promises to Beijing about the American reaction to any potential Chinese steps or vice versa.[193] He believed that Washington, along with Moscow, had taken steps to lessen tensions and sensed that the US recognized the need for revising its Asia policy. But Nehru did not think that Washington's China policy would change until at least after the American election in 1956.[194] Finally, he